5. Günter Schabowski, Press Conference in the GDR International Press Center, November 9, 1989, trans. Howard Sargeant, Cold War International History Project, Documents and Papers, Wilson Center, https://digitalarchive.wilsoncenter.org/document/113049.

6. Sarotte, *The Collapse*, xx.

7. Taylor adds, "The first reports from DPA [Deutsche Presse-Agentur] and Reuters, which came over the wires at a couple of minutes after seven p.m., simply said that any GDR citizen would be entitled, from now on, to leave the country via appropriate border crossing points. Low-key stuff. Then, at five past seven, Associated Press pulled ahead of the pack and spelled its interpretation out in a simple but sensational sentence: 'According to information provided by SED Politburo member Günter Schabowski, the GDR is opening its borders'" (Taylor, *Berlin Wall*, 425).

8. ABC News, November 9, 1989, http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jnCPdLlUgvo.

9. NBC News, November 10, 1989, http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fK1MwhEDjHg.

10. In the weeks following the initial breach of the Berlin Wall, after the wave of East German protests on the evening of November 9, Americans turned to popular culture to make meaning of this improvised historic moment. This was a process that built and revised previous patterns of cultural commentary and critique, including cautious reflection, sentimental attachments, and parody. For example, on November 18, *Saturday Night Live* comedian Mike Myers reprised his "Sprockets" skit, playing disaffected avant-garde West German TV host Dieter, as he had previously several times. In this installment, the first since the breach of the Wall, Dieter is finally able to interview fictional East German filmmaker Gregor Voss (played by guest star Woody Harrelson) days after the former "countercultural" and "suppressed visionary" is able to travel to the West for the first time. But on this segment, the spoils of capitalism have overcome Voss. He stumbles into the interview wearing a beer-can-holding helmet and proclaims, "Ich bin ein West Berliner." He has abandoned his harsh minimalist aesthetic in favor of the parodied spoils of capitalist culture, scarfing a hamburger and Mountain Dew and boasting of a rented American sedan. Even in this skit, jubilation provokes a sense of blurriness and a loss of identity. The linkages between Berlin's defunct Wall and Western consumer culture were not relegated to *Saturday Night Live*'s Sprockets but became embraced as a platform for celebratory consumerism. AT&T and Pepsi aired commercials during the subsequent Christmas season, with documentary-style footage from Berlin and sentimental soundtracks. Complementing the visuals, each commercial featured respective backing songs of Louis Armstrong's "What a Wonderful World" and Handel's *Messiah*, reinforcing the message of the Wall's dismantling as an event to be celebrated—honoring the opening for movement of people and goods across the border—through products associated with the scene. For a critical reading of the news reporting and cultural imaginary of "the fall of the wall," see Manghani, *Image Critique and the Fall of the Berlin Wall*.

11. The soundtrack for the dismantling of the Berlin Wall would also include Leonard Bernstein's "Ode to Freedom," a take on Beethoven's Ninth Symphony performed in Berlin on Christmas Day 1989, altogether introducing grand and monumental sounds to visions of the scene. Burton et al., *Ode to Freedom*. For more on consumerism and the complexities of freedom in former East Germany, see Iyengar, *Art of Choosing*.

12. This collective of cultural producers includes a range of figures who spent substantive time in Berlin—perhaps before but definitely after the *Wende* period—and/or whose work drew from the cultural imaginary of a divided Berlin. A sampling of this group, beyond others mentioned in previous chapters, includes multidisciplinary musical theater producers John Cameron Mitchell (*Hedwig and the Angry Inch*) and Stew (*Passing Strange*); novelists Chloe Aridjis (*Book of Clouds*), Paul Beatty (*Slumberland*), Jeffrey Eugenides (*Middlesex*), Janet Fitch (*White Oleander*), Jonathan Franzen (*Freedom* and *Purity*), Andrew Sean Greer (*Less*), Ida Hattemer-Higgins (*The History of History*), Aleksandar Hemon (*Lazarus Project*), and Darryl Pinckney (*Black Deutschland*); musicians David Bowie ("Where Are We Now"), Leonard Cohen (*The Future*), Ani DiFranco ("Subdivision"), Michael Jackson (*Dancing the Dream* and *HIStory*), Prince ("Wall of Berlin"), Lou Reed (*Berlin*,